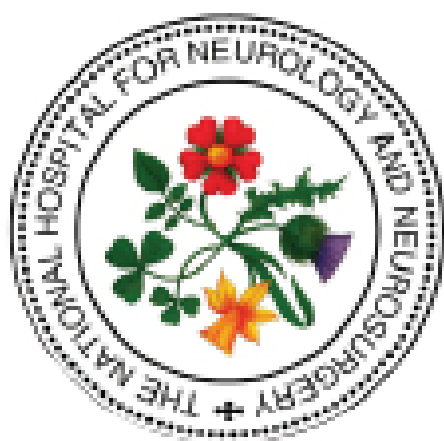




METHYLPREDNISOLONE SODIUM SUCCINATE A TREATMENT OPTION IN SPINAL SURGERY / ACUTE SPINAL CORD INJURY

INDICATIONS FOR USE

There is insufficient evidence to support the use of high-dose methylprednisolone within 8 hours following an acute closed spinal cord injury as a treatment **standard** or as a **guideline** for treatment.

However, methylprednisolone, prescribed as a bolus IV infusion of 30mg/kg of body weight over 15 minutes within 8 hours of closed spinal cord injury, followed 45 minutes later by an infusion of 5.4mg/kg of body weight per hour for 23 hours, can be used as a **treatment option** (weak clinical evidence (Level I- to II-1).

There is insufficient evidence to support extending the use of methylprednisolone infusion beyond 23 hours if chosen as a treatment option.

PRESCRIBING

Bolus dose must be prescribed as :

Drug: Methylprednisolone sodium succinate
Dose: Total bolus dose for patient (calculated as 30mg/kg)

Infusion must be prescribed as :

Drug: Methylprednisolone sodium succinate
Dose: 2g in 50ml
Infusion rate: 5.4mg/kg/h over 23 hours

COMPATABILITY

- Can be diluted with 0.9% saline or 5% dextrose
- Administer separately to avoid compatibility problems or discuss with pharmacy

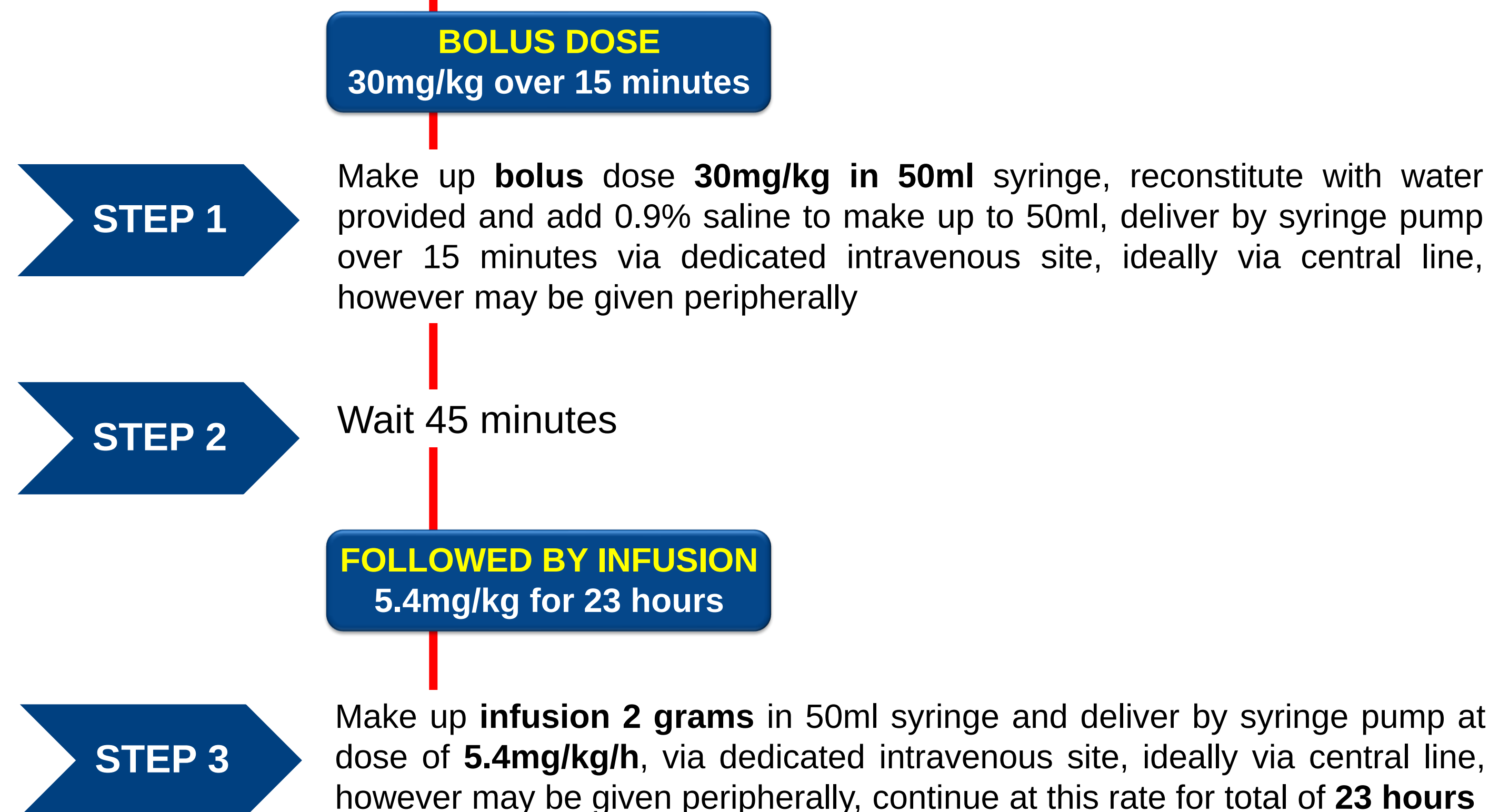
STABILITY

- Reconstituted solution to be used immediately, but stable in syringe driver for up to 24 hours
- Discard unused solutions after 24 hours

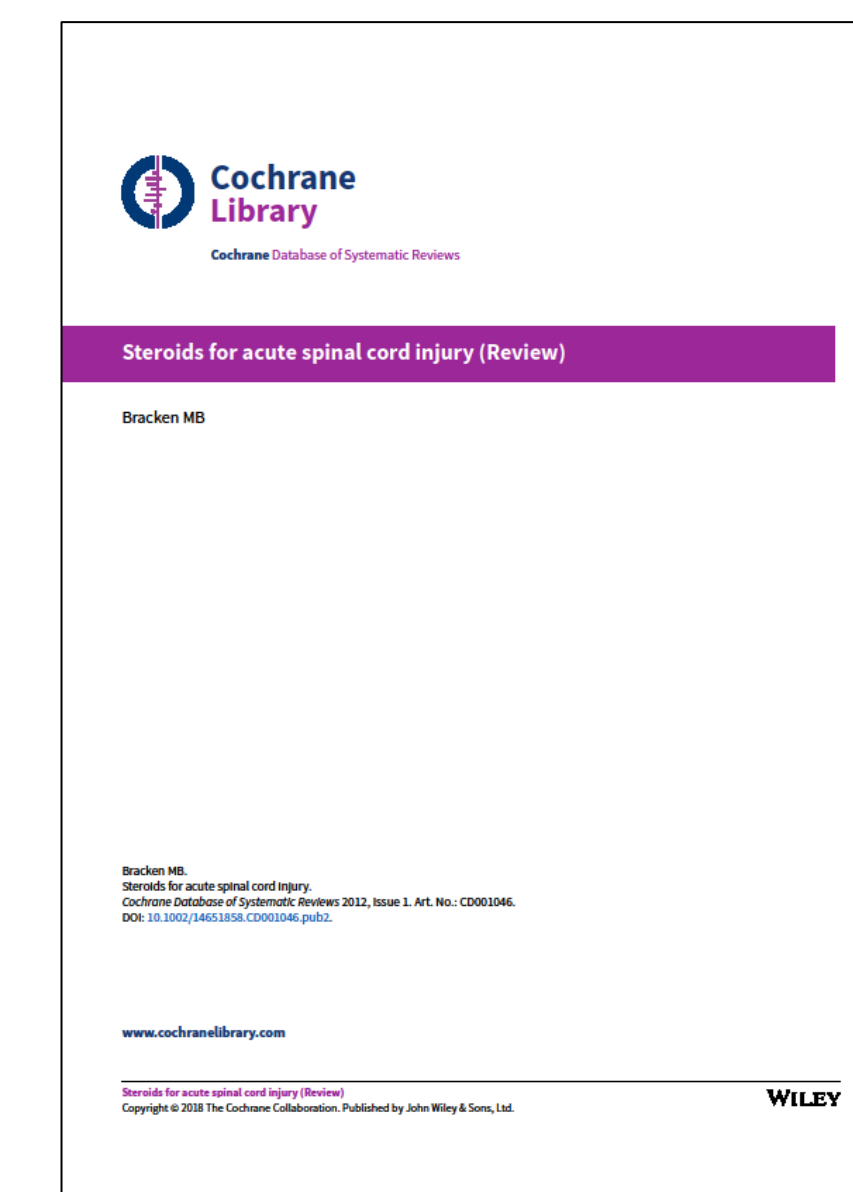
SIDE EFFECTS

- Hypersensitivity reactions
- Cardiac arrhythmias and/or circulatory collapse and/or cardiac arrest with too rapid administration of large doses
- Bradycardia during or after the administration of large doses, which may be unrelated to the speed of infusion
- Hypertension or hypotension
- Nausea, vomiting
- Bad taste in mouth (especially with rapid administration)
- Skin reactions e.g. bruising

1. ACUTE SPINAL CORD INJURY – WITHIN 8 HOURS OF INJURY 2. PERI-OPERATIVE AND POST-OPERATIVE SPINAL CORD OEDEMA



ESTIMATED WEIGHT	BOLUS DOSE 30mg/kg in 50ml infused over 15min = 200ml/h	INFUSION DOSE / RATE 5.4mg/kg/h 2g in 50ml = 40mg/ml infused over 23h
50kg	1.5g	270mg/h (6.75ml/h)
60kg	1.8g	324mg/h (8.1ml/h)
70kg	2.1g	378mg/h (9.45ml/h)
80kg	2.4g	432mg/h (10.8ml/h)
90kg	2.7g	486mg/h (12.15ml/h)
100kg	3g	540mg/h (13.5ml/h)



References

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